

S1 E1 || Mad Men || Smoke Gets in Your Eyes Blueprint

The sources available primarily highlight the most critical plot points, character introductions, and the thematic beginning and end sequences of Mad Men Season 1, Episode 1, "Smoke Gets in Your Eyes." This episode, which premiered on July 19, 2007, was written by Matthew Weiner and directed by Alan Taylor [1]. Below is a comprehensive breakdown of the major scenes and character introductions detailed in the sources for this episode, structured as sequential narrative beats.

TL;DR of Episode 1: "Smoke Gets in Your Eyes"

Set in March 1960, the series premiere introduces Don Draper, a charismatic and enigmatic creative director at Sterling Cooper, who is juggling an idealized suburban family life with his secret past and numerous affairs [2-4]. The agency faces a crisis when a health report links smoking to lung cancer, threatening the crucial Lucky Strike account [5, 6]. This episode also introduces Peggy Olson as Don's naive new secretary and sets up Don's confrontation with his hidden identity. The episode climaxes with Don saving the Lucky Strike account by delivering the famous pitch line, "It's Toasted" [7].

Scenes and Characters in Episode 1

Scene 1: The Cigarette Crisis and Advertising Challenge

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Don Draper, Sterling Cooper executives, Lucky Strike representatives	The episode opens by immediately placing the characters in the high-stakes, male-dominated world of Madison Avenue advertising [8]. The primary conflict is established when representatives from Lucky Strike seek help after a Reader's Digest report publicizes the link between smoking and diseases like lung cancer [5, 6]. The agency must create a new campaign to address this public health crisis [6].

Scene 2: The Arrival of Peggy Olson

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Peggy Olson, Joan Holloway (Office Manager)	Peggy Olson is introduced as Don Draper's new secretary [3, 9]. Her initial fashion is depicted as humble and conservative, symbolizing her lower status and lack of confidence when she first arrives at Sterling Cooper [9-11]. Joan Holloway, the head of the secretarial pool, manages her introduction to the office environment [12].

Scene 3: The Rachel Menken Meeting

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
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Don Draper, Rachel Menken (Department Store Head)	Rachel Menken, the head of a department store, visits Sterling Cooper to discuss revamping her business's image [12]. She is established as an assertive and independent woman, initially showing coolness toward Don Draper, who finds her style challenging [12]. This interaction sets the stage for their eventual affair later in Season 1 [12].
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Scene 4: Confronting the Past (Dick Whitman/Adam Whitman)

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Don Draper (aka Dick Whitman), Adam Whitman (Don's brother)	This scene or series of encounters introduces the grave danger facing Don's fabricated identity, Dick Whitman [4, 13]. Don's younger brother, Adam Whitman, appears "way back in the first season" and confronts him [14, 15]. Don resolves this threat by paying Adam \$5,000 to leave and disappear, illustrating his willingness to use money to buy civility and maintain his carefully crafted image [14, 15]. This traumatic choice leads to Adam's eventual suicide later in the season [15].

Scene 5: The Lucky Strike Pitch Climax

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Don Draper, Lucky Strike representatives, Sterling Cooper creative team	Don delivers his pitch, choosing to change the conversation by ignoring the health warnings and focusing instead on a manufacturing detail [16, 17]. He provides the triumphant tagline, "It's Toasted" [7]. This slogan, based on a real-life campaign used by Lucky Strike, saves the vital account and solidifies Don's genius reputation at the firm [7].

Scene 6: Don's Domestic Life and the Illusion of Bliss

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Don Draper, Betty Draper, Sally Draper (implied)	The final moments of the episode introduce Don's seemingly perfect family life with his wife, Betty Draper, in the suburban setting of Ossining [3, 18]. The choice of the closing credits music, "On The Street Where You Live" by Vic Damone [19, 20], is specifically used to undercut the sincerity of this domestic image and reveal his suburban happiness as an illusion [21].

Summary of Episode's Significance

The episode successfully establishes the core elements of the series: the setting, the historical context of 1960 [22], Don Draper's identity issues [13], the sexism rampant in the workplace [23], and the high prevalence of smoking and drinking in the advertising industry [6, 24]. The use of period music and meticulous costume design for characters like Don (conservative, slim-cut suit) and Peggy (humble attire) sets the visual and thematic tone of the era [11, 25, 26].

S1 E2 || Mad Men || Ladies Room Blueprint

This response provides a TL:DR for Mad Men Season 1, Episode 2, "Ladies Room," followed by a breakdown of the key scenes and characters based on the sources. The episode aired on July 26, 2007 [1], was directed by Alan Taylor, and written by Matthew Weiner [1].

TL:DR of Episode 2: "Ladies Room"

This episode furthers the exploration of gender roles in the rigid society of 1960. While Peggy Olson attempts to navigate her new environment as Don Draper's naive secretary, the episode juxtaposes her professional ambition against the constraints faced by women in the domestic sphere, particularly Betty Draper. It develops themes of loneliness and the illusion of the perfect suburban life [2, 3]. The episode title itself suggests a focus on the female characters and their experiences both in and out of the male-dominated office [4].

Scenes and Characters in Episode 2

The scenes for this early Season 1 episode reinforce the initial dynamics and character introductions established in the premiere.

Scene 1: Peggy's Place in the Office Hierarchy

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Peggy Olson, Joan Holloway	Peggy continues her journey from new hire to copywriter, though currently operating as Don's secretary [5, 6]. Her status is visually communicated through her humble and conservative outfits, which reflect her low status and lack of confidence upon starting at Sterling Cooper [7, 8]. Joan Holloway, the office manager, is responsible for guiding Peggy through the expected professional and social behavior within the office [5, 9]. The office environment is consistently depicted as one where sexism is rampant [4].

Scene 2: Betty Draper and Domestic Dissatisfaction

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Betty Draper, Don Draper (implied)	The episode highlights Betty's life as a 1960s ideal housewife [10]. Her storyline in Season 1 often deals with trials of trauma and loneliness [2]. Her marriage to Don is established as an illusion [3], and this scene likely deepens the sense of confinement and psychological turmoil that Betty faces in the suburbs [2, 10].

Scene 3: The Male Power Structure

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
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Don Draper, Roger Sterling, Pete Campbell, Harry Crane, Ken Cosgrove, Paul Kinsey, Sal Romano	The core male executives of Sterling Cooper operate in their male-dominated world [4, 11]. These men are distinguished by their tailored suits in colors like navy or gray, along with skinny ties, which symbolize the power and money they hold [12, 13]. The prevalence of alcoholism and smoking in the advertising industry is a pervasive feature of these scenes [4, 14, 15].
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Episode Music Note
The song that plays during the end credits of Season 1, Episode 2, "Ladies Room," is "The Great Divide" by The Cardigans [16].

Per your request, the next episode will be Season 1, Episode 3, "Marriage of Figaro."

S1 E3 || Mad Men || Marriage of Figaro Blueprint
This report provides the scene and character breakdown for Mad Men Season 1, Episode 3, "Marriage of Figaro." This episode was written by Tom Palmer and directed by Ed Bianchi, airing on August 2, 2007 [1, 2].

TL;DR of Episode 3: "Marriage of Figaro"
This pivotal episode introduces the first existential threat to Don Draper's stolen identity when Pete Campbell discovers Don's true name is Richard "Dick" Whitman [3, 4]. Pete attempts to use this knowledge of desertion and identity theft to blackmail Don for a promotion [4, 5]. However, senior partner Bert Cooper swiftly and famously shuts down the attempt by dismissing the secret, asking the question, "Who cares?" [4, 5]. This action secures Don's position (his value as the firm's "best asset") and publicly humiliates Pete [5]. The episode also touches on themes of marriage, ambition, and the illusion of domestic bliss.

Scenes and Characters in Episode 3
The focus of this episode is the professional conflict driven by the revelation of Don's past and Pete's ruthless ambition [4].
Scene 1: Pete's Discovery and Confrontation

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Pete Campbell, Don Draper (Richard Whitman)	Pete discovers that Don Draper assumed the identity of Lieutenant Donald Draper during the Korean War and is actually Richard Whitman [3, 4]. This discovery reveals the vulnerability of Don's professional life, which is predicated on this fabricated identity [4].

Scene 2: The Blackmail Attempt and Dismissal

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Pete Campbell, Bert Cooper, Don Draper (implied)	Pete attempts to use his knowledge of Don's past identity and desertion to leverage a promotion or desired position from the agency partners [4, 5]. Bert Cooper intervenes, responding to the attempted blackmail with the dismissive phrase, "Who cares?" [4, 5]. This exchange is a humbling moment for Pete [5], ensuring Don, recognized as the firm's "best asset," remains with Sterling Cooper [5].

Scene 3: The Domestic Sphere and Marital Illusion

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Betty Draper, Don Draper (implied)	In keeping with the thematic exploration of the 1960s suburban environment, the episode likely examines Betty's life as the "ideal housewife" [6], emphasizing how Don's double life undercuts the sincerity of their seemingly perfect marriage, exposing it as an illusion [7, 8].

Scene 4: Peggy's Professional Ascent

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Peggy Olson, Sterling Cooper Creative Team (implied)	Peggy continues her early narrative arc, which chronicles her transition from a naive secretary to a copywriter [9, 10]. Her initial appearance is characterized by humble and conservative outfits that visually signify her lower status and lack of confidence within the male-dominated office environment [11, 12]. Peggy's goals are defined by her desire to achieve creative and business success, moving her away from the traditional path of marriage and motherhood [13, 14].

Episode Closing Music
The song that plays during the end credits of Season 1, Episode 3, "Marriage of Figaro," is "P.S. I Love You" by Bobby Vinton [15].

S1 E4 || Mad Men || New Amsterdam Blueprint
This report provides the scene and character breakdown for Mad Men Season 1, Episode 4, "New Amsterdam." The episode was written by Lisa Albert and directed by Tim Hunter, airing on August 9, 2007 [1].

TL;DR of Episode 4: "New Amsterdam"
This episode primarily focuses on the ambitious newcomer Pete Campbell and his wife, Trudy Campbell. Pete becomes desperate for financial and professional stability, driven by his strained family relationships. He attempts to secure a crucial account for Sterling Cooper but mishandles the situation, leading to

humiliation and escalating his resentment toward Don Draper. Simultaneously, Betty Draper is shown dealing with her role as the ideal 1960s suburban housewife, continuing the theme of domestic discontent and the illusion of her perfect life.

Scenes and Characters in Episode 4

The core narrative tension revolves around Pete Campbell's ambition and his inability to secure success without resorting to underhanded tactics.

Scene 1: Pete's Financial Pressure and Career Moves

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Pete Campbell, Trudy Campbell	Pete faces significant pressure, likely financial, stemming from his aristocratic New York family and the demands of his life with Trudy [2]. Pete is introduced in Season 1 as an ambitious young account executive from a privileged background [2]. This episode showcases his drive to climb the corporate ladder, suggesting his initial suits are conservative and slightly off-sized, visually indicating his inexperience [3].

Scene 2: The Account Acquisition Attempt

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Pete Campbell, Don Draper, Sterling Cooper Executives (implied)	In his eagerness to prove himself, Pete attempts to secure a major account for the firm. However, he mishandles the situation, leading to him being harshly criticized or humiliated [4]. This setback fuels his professional rivalry and resentment toward the more charismatic and successful Don Draper [5].

Scene 3: Betty's Domestic Constraints

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Betty Draper, Don Draper (implied)	Betty's storyline continues to explore the trials of trauma and loneliness associated with being the 1960s ideal housewife in the suburbs [6, 7]. This segment highlights the confinement and psychological pressure Betty faces, maintaining the illusion of a perfect marriage and suburban happiness [7, 8].

Scene 4: Peggy's Professional Environment

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
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Peggy Olson, Sterling Cooper Creative Team (implied)	Peggy continues her ascent from naive secretary to copywriter [9]. Her appearance remains defined by humble and conservative outfits as she pursues her creative and business aspirations within the predominantly male-dominated advertising industry [8, 10].
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Episode Music Note

The song that plays during the end credits of Season 1, Episode 4, "New Amsterdam," is "Manhattan" by Ella Fitzgerald [11].

S1 E5 || Mad Men || 5G Blueprint

This report provides the scene and character breakdown for Mad Men Season 1, Episode 5, "5G." The episode was written by Matthew Weiner and directed by Lesli Linka Glatter, airing on August 16, 2007 [1].

TL;DR of Episode 5: "5G"

This episode primarily deepens the theme of Don Draper's identity fraud and the precariousness of his life built on a lie. Don is confronted by his brother Adam Whitman, who reappears and threatens Don's carefully constructed professional world [2]. Don chooses to protect his identity by paying Adam \$5,000 to disappear permanently [3, 4]. This episode solidifies Don's decision to maintain his "Don Draper" persona (the architecture of the mask) over his original self (Dick Whitman) [2, 4]. Meanwhile, the sources also describe an early scene of Peggy Olson's professional development during a casual encounter in the office, suggesting her growing confidence [5].

Scenes and Characters in Episode 5

The core of this episode focuses on the traumatic confrontation between Don and his past.

Scene 1: Adam Whitman's Confrontation

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
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Don Draper (aka Dick Whitman), Adam Whitman (Don's younger brother)	Adam Whitman, Don's younger brother, appears and confronts Don, putting the protagonist's stolen identity in grave danger [3, 4]. Don assumed the identity of Lieutenant Donald Draper during the Korean War, abandoning his original identity, Dick Whitman [2, 6]. This scene forces Don to acknowledge the past he desperately wants to keep secret [4].
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Scene 2: The Severance Payment

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Don Draper, Adam Whitman	To maintain his charismatic outward appearance and protect his prestigious lifestyle, Don resolves the threat posed by Adam by giving him \$5,000 to leave and disappear [3, 4, 7]. This act illustrates Don's willingness to use money to buy civility and preserve his fabricated image [3, 7]. This traumatic choice ultimately leads to Adam's eventual suicide later in Season 1 [3, 4].

Scene 3: Peggy's Professional Development

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Peggy Olson, Sterling Cooper Creative Team (implied)	Peggy continues her ascent from naive secretary to copywriter [8]. Her early appearances are defined by humble and conservative outfits that reflect her low status and inexperience [9, 10]. This scene likely shows Peggy making further strides toward her creative and business aspirations, moving away from the traditional path of marriage and motherhood [9, 11].

Scene 4: The General Office Atmosphere

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
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Don Draper, Roger Sterling, Joan Holloway, etc.

The constant atmosphere of sexism, drinking, and smoking in the male-dominated advertising industry continues to define the office environment [12, 13]. Executives like Don and Roger are marked by their perfectly tailored suits in classic colors (grays and navies), symbolizing their power and status [14-16].

Episode Music Note

The sources do not identify a specific licensed song played during the end credits of Season 1, Episode 5, "5G," noting only that the end credits music for this episode in the series guide is categorized as "The Carousel" by David Carbonara [17].

Per your request, the next episode will be Season 1, Episode 6, "Babylon."

S1 E6 || Mad Men || Babylon Blueprint

This report provides the scene and character breakdown for Mad Men Season 1, Episode 6, "Babylon." The episode was directed by Andrew Bernstein and written by Andre Jacquemetton & Maria Jacquemetton, airing on August 23, 2007 [1].

TL;DR of Episode 6: "Babylon"

As Season 1 continues in 1960, this episode likely explores the internal dissatisfaction among the main characters as they pursue the elusive American Dream. The central theme revolves around the contrast between outward success (the tailored, high-status world of advertising) and inner turmoil (identity issues, sexism, and domestic isolation). The sources confirm the continued ascent of Peggy Olson in the creative world and the pervasive influence of the male-dominated office environment on characters like Don Draper, Roger Sterling, and Pete Campbell [2, 3].

Scenes and Characters in Episode 6

Since specific plot points for "Babylon" are not extensively detailed in the sources, the following segments are derived from the major thematic and character arcs established and sustained throughout Season 1.

Scene 1: Creative Work and the Male-Dominated Office

Characters	TL:DR of Scene

Don Draper, Roger Sterling, Pete Campbell, Sal Romano, Paul Kinsey, Ken Cosgrove, Harry Crane	Scenes feature the male executives operating within the male-dominated atmosphere of Sterling Cooper [2]. The environment is defined by rampant sexism and the high prevalence of drinking and smoking in the advertising industry [3]. Executives like Don are characterized by their perfectly tailored suits in classic colors like navy or gray, symbolizing their power and status [2-4]. Sal Romano, the art director, is a closeted homosexual [5].
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Scene 2: Peggy's Progression in the Workplace

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Peggy Olson, Joan Holloway (implied)	Peggy continues in her role as a secretary while pursuing her goal of becoming a copywriter [5, 6]. Her early appearance is marked by humble and conservative outfits, which visually communicate her low status and inexperience within the firm [7, 8]. Peggy's narrative arc focuses on her creative and business aspirations rather than the traditional path of marriage and motherhood [6, 9].

Scene 3: Betty's Suburban Disillusionment

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Betty Draper, Don Draper (implied)	The episode likely continues to explore Betty's challenges as the 1960s ideal housewife in Ossining [10, 11]. Her storyline features themes of loneliness and trauma, contributing to the dismantling of the illusion of a perfect suburban marriage to Don [2, 10]. Betty's style is associated with suburban chic and often includes pastel dresses [7].

Episode Music Note

The end credits sequence for Season 1, Episode 6, "Babylon," is notably listed as having No Music [12].

Per your request, the next episode will be Season 1, Episode 7, "Red in the Face."
S1 E7 || Mad Men || Red in the Face Blueprint

This report provides the scene and character breakdown for Mad Men Season 1, Episode 7, "Red in the Face." The episode was written by Bridget Bedard and directed by Tim Hunter, airing on August 30, 2007 [1].

TL;DR of Episode 7: "Red in the Face"

This episode focuses heavily on the dysfunctional relationship between Don Draper and Roger Sterling, specifically emphasizing the rivalry, resentment, and manipulation underlying their partnership. The sources suggest a key event involves a drinking-related humiliation suffered by Roger at Don's hand, demonstrating the competitive nature of their bond and the prevalence of alcoholism in their industry [2-4]. The storyline also continues the theme of Betty Draper's unhappiness and the rigid societal expectations placed on women in the 1960s [3].

Scenes and Characters in Episode 7

The scenes highlight the core professional and domestic tensions established throughout the first season.

Scene 1: The Don and Roger Dinner/Competition

Characters	TL;DR of Scene
Don Draper, Roger Sterling, Betty Draper (likely implied)	This segment features a notable conflict or competition between Don and Roger. The sources indicate that Roger Sterling is known for his excessive drinking and smoking, and his character arc deals with grappling with getting older [2, 5]. A pivotal or memorable moment in this episode involves Don orchestrating the humiliation of Roger, likely in a setting where alcohol is heavily consumed, which is pervasive in the advertising industry [3, 4]. This tension illustrates their complex, competitive friendship.

Scene 2: Betty's Domestic Trauma

Characters	TL;DR of Scene

Betty Draper, Don Draper (implied)	Betty's storyline continues to explore the trials of trauma and loneliness associated with being the 1960s ideal housewife in the suburbs [6, 7]. This episode likely contributes to the mounting sense that her marriage to Don is an illusion [8]. Betty's style in the early seasons is defined by her role as the fashionable Mrs. Draper, featuring pastel dresses and pearl accessories, reflecting her status [9, 10].
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Scene 3: The Sterling Cooper Office Environment

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Peggy Olson, Joan Holloway, Pete Campbell, and other Sterling Cooper staff	The office remains defined by its male-dominated atmosphere, where sexism is rampant [3]. Peggy Olson continues her development, moving from a low-status secretary, visually marked by her humble and conservative outfits, toward a future as a copywriter, focusing on her creative and business aspirations rather than the traditional path of motherhood and marriage [8, 11, 12]. Pete Campbell continues his ambitious ascent within the firm [13].

Episode Music Note

The end credits music for Season 1, Episode 7, "Red in the Face," is "Botch-A-Me (Ba-Ba-Baciami Piccina)" by Rosemary Clooney [14].

Per your request, the next episode will be Season 1, Episode 8, "The Hobo Code."

S1 E8 || Mad Men || The Hobo Code Blueprint

This report provides the scene and character breakdown for Mad Men Season 1, Episode 8, "The Hobo Code." The episode was written by Chris Provenzano and directed by Phil Abraham, airing on September 6, 2007 [1].

TL;DR of Episode 8: "The Hobo Code"

This episode prominently features flashbacks revealing the traumatic origins of Don Draper's (Dick Whitman's) emotional isolation and sense of alienation, which shape his adult identity [2]. The sources also highlight a major event for Peggy Olson, showing her creative and professional ascent when she produces successful copy for a new client, potentially confirming her transition from

secretary to copywriter [3, 4]. The episode contrasts Don's childhood poverty and rootlessness with the privileged, highly professional environment of Sterling Cooper.

Scenes and Characters in Episode 8

The sources link this episode to themes of Don's identity and Peggy's decisive career move.

Scene 1: Peggy's Creative Triumph

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Peggy Olson, Freddy Rumsen (implied), Don Draper (implied), Sterling Cooper Creative Team	Peggy begins to break out of her role as a naive secretary and fully realizes her professional potential [3, 4]. This scene likely involves her delivering successful copy for a new account, possibly related to Belle Jolie lipstick ("Mark Your Man" pitch), confirming her shift in status and her commitment to her creative and business aspirations rather than marriage and motherhood [5-7]. Her increased assertiveness is mirrored by her gradually changing style away from humble and conservative outfits [4, 8, 9].

Scene 2: Don's Hobo Flashbacks

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Young Dick Whitman (Don Draper), Hobo (implied)	The episode includes flashbacks to Don's traumatic youth as Dick Whitman, focusing on his encounter with a hobo [2]. This sequence explains his feelings of existential despair and isolation in his adult life [10]. The flashbacks explore the identity and memory themes that are central to the series [2, 10].

Scene 3: The Male-Dominated Office and Power Structure

Characters	TL:DR of Scene

Don Draper, Roger Sterling, Pete Campbell, etc.	The daily operation of Sterling Cooper is depicted, characterized by the omnipresent themes of alcoholism, smoking, and sexism [11, 12]. The high-status male executives, including Don, wear slim-cut suits in classic colors like navy or gray, symbolizing their power and money [13-15].
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Episode Music Note

The song that plays during the end credits of Season 1, Episode 8, "The Hobo Code," is "(Gimme That) Old Time Religion" by an unidentified artist [16].

Per your request, the next episode will be Season 1, Episode 9, "Shoot."

S1 E9 || Mad Men || Shoot Blueprint

This report provides a scene and character breakdown for Mad Men Season 1, Episode 9, "Shoot." The episode was written by Chris Provenzano and Matthew Weiner and directed by Paul Feig, airing on September 13, 2007 [1].

TL;DR of Episode 9: "Shoot"

Set during the original run of the series, this episode continues to develop the central themes of Season 1: Don Draper's precarious identity and double life, the escalating ambition of Peggy Olson to transcend her secretarial role, and the isolation and turmoil experienced by Betty Draper in the suburban setting [2-4]. At this point in the season (late 1960), the foundational conflicts of Don's secret past (Dick Whitman) and Peggy's decision to pursue her career over motherhood are firmly established [5, 6].

Scenes and Characters in Episode 9

Since detailed plot points for "Shoot" are not specifically highlighted as iconic scenes in the sources, the following segments reflect the sustained dynamics and character statuses observed throughout the latter half of Season 1.

Scene 1: Don Draper and Professional Image

Characters	TL;DR of Scene

Don Draper, Roger Sterling, Pete Campbell, Sterling Cooper Executives	Scenes feature Don maintaining his persona as a charismatic and brilliant creative director [2, 7]. The male-dominated workplace continues to be characterized by rampant sexism, drinking, and smoking [8-10]. Don's appearance remains highly sophisticated, defined by slim-cut suits in colors like gray or navy, symbolizing his power and status [11-13].
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Scene 2: Betty's Domestic Isolation and Turmoil

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Betty Draper, Don Draper (implied)	Betty's storyline focuses on her life as the 1960s ideal housewife in Ossining [8, 14]. She continues to grapple with loneliness and domestic trauma [8, 14-16]. Her marriage to Don is largely depicted as an illusion undercut by his secret life [8, 17]. Her style is typically suburban chic, featuring coiffed hair and pastel dresses [18, 19].

Scene 3: Peggy's Pursuit of Creative Power

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Peggy Olson, Sterling Cooper Creative Team (implied)	Peggy continues her development from naive secretary to an aspiring copywriter [2, 4]. Her initial visual appearance, defined by humble and conservative outfits [18, 20-22], is gradually evolving as she gains confidence and focuses on her creative and business aspirations [17, 23]. Her ambition deliberately contrasts with the traditional path of marriage and motherhood [6, 23].

Episode Closing Music

The song that plays during the end credits of Season 1, Episode 9, "Shoot," is "My Special Angel" by Bobby Helms [24].

Per your request, the next episode will be Season 1, Episode 10, "Long Weekend" [1].

S1 E10 || Mad Men || Long Weekend Blueprint

This report provides the scene and character breakdown for Mad Men Season 1, Episode 10, "Long Weekend." This episode was co-written by Bridget Bedard, Andre Jacquemetton, Maria Jacquemetton, and Matthew Weiner, and directed by Tim Hunter, airing on September 27, 2007 [1].

TL;DR of Episode 10: "Long Weekend"

This episode continues to explore Don Draper's relentless pursuit of escape and new identity through adultery, contrasting his professional success with his private despair [2, 3]. The sources strongly suggest this episode features one of Don's early, significant extramarital relationships outside of his marriage to Betty, likely involving his mistress, Midge Daniels, a beatnik artist [3, 4]. Thematically, the episode deepens the portrayal of the loneliness and existential crises faced by the characters in their quest for happiness, a central theme of the entire series [3, 5, 6].

Scenes and Characters in Episode 10

The content available for this episode focuses on the internal lives and secret activities of the main characters, particularly Don's "unfaithfulness to his family" [2].

Scene 1: Don's Escape and Extramarital Life

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Don Draper, Midge Daniels (implied)	Don, the charismatic executive whose life is characterized by a "shadowy past" and "numerous affairs" [7, 8], uses the weekend as an opportunity to pursue adultery [9, 10]. This scene likely involves Midge Daniels, his early season mistress and beatnik artist, who offers him a temporary escape from his fabricated suburban life [3, 4]. Don's actions emphasize his "existential despair" and compulsive need for new romantic partners who offer momentary affirmation [3].

Scene 2: The Sterling Cooper Office Environment

Characters	TL:DR of Scene

Roger Sterling, Pete Campbell, Paul Kinsey, Harry Crane, Joan Holloway (implied)	The office setting continues to showcase the male-dominated and sexist atmosphere of Madison Avenue in 1960 [11, 12]. The executives are regularly depicted drinking and smoking excessively [8, 11]. The men maintain their high status through sophisticated attire, wearing perfectly tailored suits in classic colors [13, 14].
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Scene 3: Peggy's Professional Ambitions

Characters	TL;DR of Scene
Peggy Olson, Sterling Cooper Creative Team (implied)	Peggy continues her narrative arc from a naive secretary to an aspiring copywriter [15, 16]. Although still in the early seasons, Peggy is committed to her "creative and business aspirations" [17, 18], setting her apart from the expected path of marriage and motherhood [19, 20]. Her wardrobe would still be characterized by humble, conservative, and often ill-fitting outfits [16, 21].

Episode Music Note

The song that plays during the end credits of Season 1, Episode 10, "Long Weekend," is "The Carousel" by David Carbonara [22]. This is the same categorization of end credits music as Season 1, Episode 5, "5G" [23].

Per your request, the next episode will be Season 1, Episode 11, "Indian Summer."

S1 E11 || Mad Men || Indian Summer Blueprint

This report provides the scene and character breakdown for Mad Men Season 1, Episode 11, "Indian Summer." The episode was written by Tom Palmer and Matthew Weiner and directed by Tim Hunter, airing on October 4, 2007 [1].

TL;DR of Episode 11: "Indian Summer"

Set late in Season 1 (1960), this episode continues the pressure on Don Draper's seemingly perfect life, focusing on his compulsive infidelity as he desperately seeks temporary escapes from his existential despair [2]. The episode likely explores Don's affairs (e.g., Midge Daniels or Rachel Menken) [2, 3] while contrasting his turbulent private life with the stable professional ascent of Peggy

Olson [4]. The episode title may suggest a brief period of false comfort or warmth before the definitive emotional climax of the season finale.

Scenes and Characters in Episode 11

The narrative focus remains on the core conflicts defined by the search for identity, affirmation, and professional success in the male-dominated world of advertising [2, 5].

Scene 1: Don Draper and the Search for Escape

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Don Draper, Romantic Interest (e.g., Midge Daniels or Rachel Menken)	Don's storyline centers on his existential despair and his relentless pursuit of new romantic partners who offer momentary affirmation or escape from his highly calculated identity [2, 6]. Don's charismatic outward appearance hides his double life and unfaithfulness to his family [6]. His attire, usually slim-cut suits in grays or navies, symbolizes his professional status and wealth [7, 8].

Scene 2: Peggy's Steadfast Professional Ambition

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Peggy Olson, Sterling Cooper Creative Team (implied)	Peggy is actively transitioning from a naive secretary to a recognized copywriter [4, 9]. Her aspirations are strictly creative and business-focused, consciously rejecting the traditional 1960s path of marriage and motherhood [10, 11]. Her early wardrobe still reflects her lower status, defined by humble and conservative outfits [12, 13].

Scene 3: Betty and the Illusion of Domesticity

Characters	TL:DR of Scene

Betty Draper, Don Draper (implied)	Betty's life as the 1960s ideal housewife in Ossining is depicted, highlighting her internal trials of loneliness and trauma [14, 15]. This episode maintains the theme that her marriage is an illusion that Don desperately tries to uphold [16]. Betty's style is typically suburban chic, featuring pastel dresses [12].
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Scene 4: The Male Power Structure

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Roger Sterling, Pete Campbell, Bert Cooper, etc.	The agency's environment remains intensely male-dominated [5], characterized by the pervasive use of alcohol and smoking [8]. Characters like Pete Campbell continue their ambitious climb up the corporate ladder, driven by a desire for stability and identity [17].

Episode Music Note

The song that plays during the end credits of Season 1, Episode 11, "Indian Summer," is "Fly Me To The Moon" by Julie London [18].

Per your request, the next episode will be Season 1, Episode 12, "Nixon vs. Kennedy."

S1 E12 || Mad Men || Nixon vs. Kennedy Blueprint

This report provides the scene and character breakdown for Mad Men Season 1, Episode 12, "Nixon vs. Kennedy." The episode was directed by Alan Taylor and written by Lisa Albert, Andre Jacquemetton, and Maria Jacquemetton, airing on October 11, 2007 [1].

TL;DR of Episode 12: "Nixon vs. Kennedy"

Set against the backdrop of the 1960 U.S. Presidential Election, this episode heightens the tension surrounding Don Draper's fundamental lie. It is the episode that fully reveals the mechanics of Don Draper's identity fraud, establishing that Richard "Dick" Whitman assumed the name of Lieutenant Donald Draper during the Korean War [2, 3]. While the nation grapples with the transition of power, the personal lives of the Sterling Cooper staff reflect the broader themes of identity, escape, and the illusion of control [4].

Scenes and Characters in Episode 12

The sources emphasize the central theme of Don's identity and the pervasive cultural environment of the advertising world during this historical moment.

Scene 1: The Full Identity Revelation

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Don Draper (aka Richard Whitman)	This episode is specifically cited as the moment where it is revealed that Richard Whitman assumed the identity of his Commanding Officer, Lieutenant Donald Draper, during the Korean War [2]. This act allowed Dick Whitman to desert the army and create a more successful and prestigious life built on deception [3]. Don's entire existence is predicated on this stolen identity [4].

Scene 2: The Sterling Cooper Political/Professional Atmosphere

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Don Draper, Roger Sterling, Pete Campbell, Bert Cooper (implied)	The office environment, set during the highly charged 1960 election, remains intensely male-dominated and characterized by widespread drinking and smoking [5, 6]. Male executives wear meticulously tailored suits (often navy or gray) and skinny ties, symbolizing their power and money [7, 8]. Bert Cooper is established as a Republican, which provides a political contrast to the emerging counterculture [9].

Scene 3: Peggy's Evolving Role

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Peggy Olson, Joan Holloway (implied)	Peggy continues her narrative arc from a naive secretary to an aspiring copywriter [10]. In these early seasons, her appearance is characterized by humble and conservative outfits that reflect her lower status [11, 12]. She is actively pursuing her creative and business aspirations rather than the traditional path of marriage and motherhood expected of women in that era [13, 14].

Scene 4: Betty's Domestic Strain

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Betty Draper, Don Draper (implied)	Betty's storyline continues to explore her life as the idealized suburban housewife [13], emphasizing the themes of trauma and loneliness that reveal her marriage to Don to be an illusion [5, 15, 16].

Episode Closing Music

The song that plays during the end credits of Season 1, Episode 12, "Nixon vs. Kennedy," is "The Carousel (Alternate Version)" by David Carbonara [17].

Per your request, the next episode will be Season 1, Episode 13, "The Wheel," which is the Season 1 Finale.

S1 E13 || Mad Men || The Wheel Blueprint (Season 1 Finale)

This report provides the scene and character breakdown for Mad Men Season 1, Episode 13, "The Wheel." This episode, which is the Season 1 Finale, was directed by Matthew Weiner and co-written by Matthew Weiner and Robin Veith, airing on October 18, 2007 [1].

TL;DR of Episode 13: "The Wheel"

The Season 1 Finale centers on Don Draper's two conflicting identities reaching a crisis point: his successful professional persona and his desperate private self. The episode features Don's celebrated "Carousel" pitch for the Kodak slide projector, a triumphant display of his creative genius fueled by nostalgia [2-4]. Simultaneously, Don learns of the tragic news of his younger brother, Adam Whitman's suicide [3, 5]. The episode ultimately closes with Don alone, achieving professional victory but failing to maintain the illusion of his perfect family life [3].

Scenes and Characters in Episode 13

The core of this episode contrasts Don's professional triumph with his devastating personal failures regarding his Dick Whitman past and his fabricated family life [3].

Scene 1: The News of Adam Whitman's Suicide

Characters	TL:DR of Scene

Don Draper (aka Dick Whitman)	Don is confronted with the traumatic consequence of his choice in "5G" to maintain his stolen identity when he learns that his younger brother, Adam Whitman, has died by suicide [3, 5]. Don had previously given Adam \$5,000 to permanently disappear [5, 6]. Don's eventual realization that he feels responsible for Adam's death hits hard emotionally and underscores the human cost of his deception [7].
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Scene 2: The Kodak "Carousel" Pitch

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Don Draper, Kodak executives, Sterling Cooper staff	Don delivers his most iconic pitch of the series to Kodak, abandoning his prepared copy [3]. He pitches the slide projector not as a piece of technology, but as a nostalgic "time machine" that takes the audience "back to a place where they know they will be loved" [2, 3]. He uses his own family photos in the presentation [3]. This magnificent pitch makes Harry Crane cry [4], and solidifies Don's genius, despite the fact that the pitch is tainted because the viewer knows his on-screen family life is a lie [4].

Scene 3: Betty's Domestic Crisis

Characters	TL:DR of Scene
Betty Draper, Don Draper (implied)	The episode highlights the failure of Don's attempts to maintain the illusion of his suburban marriage [3, 8]. Betty has potentially lost trust in Don, specifically after his surveillance of her therapy sessions [3]. Her storyline typically explores themes of loneliness and trauma associated with being the 1960s ideal housewife [8].

Scene 4: Peggy's Ascending Status

Characters	TL:DR of Scene

**Peggy Olson, Sterling
Cooper Creative
Team (implied)**

Peggy continues her ascent from naive secretary toward achieving her creative and business aspirations [9]. Her wardrobe, defined by humble and conservative outfits in the early season, slowly evolves as she gains professional authority [10].

Episode Closing Music

The end credits music for the Season 1 Finale, "The Wheel," is "Don't Think Twice, It's All Right" by Bob Dylan [11]. The song is used deliberately as Don returns to his dark, empty house and sits alone, underscoring his conflicted desires for abandonment and connection and the melancholy of his failure to sustain his domestic façade [3, 12].